



Plants for clay soil

Moisture retentive and rich in nutrients, clay soils provide the perfect home for a whole host of garden plants, including roses, peonies, and clematis.

Cottage borders filled with black-eyed Susan, aster, columbine, and beebalm, or traditional shrub and perennial schemes will all thrive in clay soils in the sun. If you have modern designs in mind, you can opt for bamboo, canna, and Culver's root. Although clay soil can be a little difficult to manage, if treated the right way it can be extremely fertile. Clay is prone to waterlogging and cracking during dry spells, but these problems can be remedied by applying a mulch of organic material every year in spring. This will help to improve the structure of the clay and increase drainage.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Amsonia tabernaemontana
WILLOW BLUE-STAR An upright perennial with slim tapering leaves that develop attractive tints before dropping in fall. It produces clusters of star-shaped blue flowers from late spring to summer. Grow in front of or in the center of a flowerbed.
↑↔3ft (1m)
☹ ⚠ Z3-9 Ⓝ



PERENNIAL LARGE

Aster novae-angliae
Renamed Symphyotrichum novae-angliae This New England aster has slim hairy leaves and, purple, pink, red, or white daisy-like flowers from late summer to fall. Best in neutral to alkaline soils; it has mildew resistance.
↑up to 5ft (1.5m) ↔24in (60cm)
☹ Z4-8 Ⓝ



PERENNIAL LARGE

Anemone hupehensis
CHINESE ANEMONE A perennial with dark green divided leaves. Tall upright stems of purple, red, pink, or white flowers with yellow eyes appear over many weeks from late summer to early fall. 'Hadspen Abundance' (above) has pale pink blooms.
↑4ft (1.2m) ↔18in (45cm)
☹ Z5-7 Ⓝ



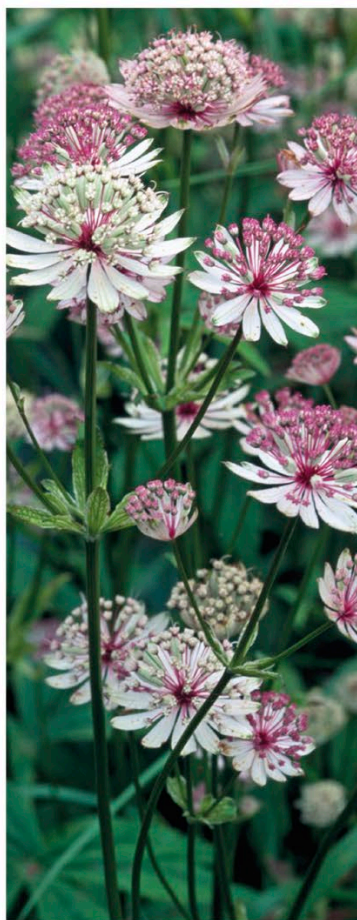
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astilbe 'Venus'
ASTILBE This perennial has divided foliage topped with feathery tapering plumes of tiny pale pink flowers in midsummer. The seedheads become dry and provide interest well into winter. Divide every 3-4 years. Needs moisture if planted in full sun.
↑↔3ft (1m)
☹ Z3-8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aconitum 'Stainless Steel'
MONKSHOOD A clump-forming perennial with deeply divided dark green leaves and dense upright spikes of unusual, silvery blue hooded flowers, which appear from mid- to late summer. All parts of the plant are poisonous.
↑3ft (1m) ↔24in (60cm)
☹ ⚠ Z4-8



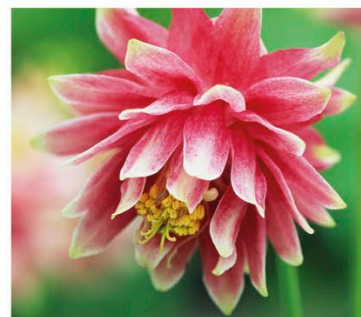
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astrantia major
MASTERWORT A clump-forming perennial, with divided midgreen leaves. It produces sprays of small greenish white, pink, or red flowers from midsummer to early fall. Deadhead regularly to prolong the display. Remove spent growth in fall.
↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)
☹ Z4-7



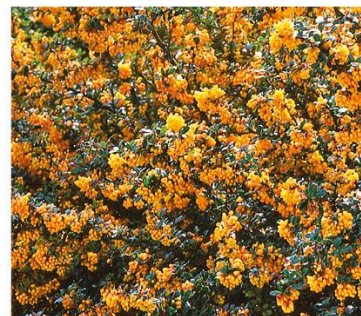
ANNUAL/BIENNIAL LARGE

Amaranthus caudatus
LOVE-LIES-BLEEDING This is a tall, bushy annual with oval pale green leaves. From summer to fall, it produces long, pendulous, tassel-like red flowers, which are good for cutting and can be used for indoor displays.
↑4ft (1.2m) ↔18in (45cm)
☹



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aquilegia vulgaris
var. stellata
COLUMBINE An upright perennial with round leaves and pompomlike flowers from late spring to early summer. Deadhead after flowering. 'Nora Barlow' (above) has greenish pink blooms with white tips.
↑30in (75cm) ↔20in (50cm)
☹ Z3-8



SHRUB LARGE

Berberis darwinii
DARWIN'S BARBERRY This vigorous, arching evergreen shrub has small, glossy dark green leaves. Numerous rounded, deep orange-yellow flowers appear from mid- to late spring, followed by bluish berries. Its vicious spines are good for security hedges.
↑↔10ft (3m)
☹ ⚠ Z7-9